

# Teacher Guide

*Heidi · Chapter 1: Going Up to the Alm-Uncle · Grade 3*

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## Lesson Overview

- **Heidi:** She has rosy cheeks and tanned skin. She is five years old. She is curious, cheerful, and free-spirited. She takes off her clothes when she is hot and greets her grandfather warmly. This shows she is confident and adaptable.
- **Grandfather (Alm-Uncle):** He has a long gray beard and bushy eyebrows that meet in the middle. He carries a twisted walking stick. He lives alone and does not talk to people. He seems gruff but his face softens when Heidi arrives. This shows he is guarded but not completely cold.
- **Peter:** He is eleven years old. He herds goats and knows the mountain well. He does not say much but grins when Heidi joins him in her simple clothes. He runs quickly when offered a coin. This shows he is quiet, practical, and motivated by small rewards.

Students draw Heidi taking off her heavy clothes and shoes on the mountain path. Encourage students to include the goats, Peter, and the mountain path in the background. This activity reinforces the key image of Heidi's free and joyful nature that runs throughout the chapter.

Students complete three sentence stems. Accept any reasonable answer that connects to what they drew and what they learned from the chapter. Encourage students to use specific details rather than vague statements.

Students number the events from the chapter in the correct order. The correct sequence is listed below.

1. Deta and Heidi climb the mountain path from Maienfeld on a sunny morning in June. — **1**
2. Barbara joins Deta and tells her, "You must be out of your mind to consider it." — **2**
3. Deta explains that Tobias learned carpentry and was very responsible, unlike his father, Alm-Uncle. — **3**
4. Deta said goodbye to Barbara near this hut, and Barbara continued her journey up the mountain. — **4**
5. Heidi takes off her heavy shoes, socks, and extra dresses, and Peter retrieves them after Deta gives him a coin. — **5**
6. Heidi, Peter, and the goats reach Alm-Uncle's hut, and Heidi calls out, "Good evening, Grandfather!" — **6**
7. It was an adventure for her, and she was eager to explore every corner of her grandfather's hut. — **7**

Students write a prediction about what will happen in Chapter 2. Accept any prediction that is reasonable based on what was introduced in Chapter 1. Look for predictions that connect to character details, such as how Grandfather will respond to Heidi, whether Heidi will be happy on the mountain, or what Peter's role will be going forward.

There is no single correct answer.

- Why do you think Heidi is so cheerful even though she is being left with someone she does not know?
- How does Deta feel about leaving Heidi? Do you think she feels guilty? What makes you think that?
- What do we learn about Alm-Uncle from the way other people talk about him? Is that the same as who he really seems to be?
- Peter does not say very much in this chapter. What can we still learn about him from what he does?
- Some students may confuse Deta's relationship to Heidi. Deta is Heidi's aunt, not her mother. Heidi's mother, Adelheid, was Deta's sister and died when Heidi was very young.
- Students may not understand why the old man is called "Alm-Uncle" if he is not anyone's uncle. The text explains that the village started calling him "Uncle" as a general title, and when he moved to the Alm (the mountain pasture), the name became "Alm-Uncle."
- The word *treasure* in this chapter means something precious or special, not gold or buried riches. Help students connect this meaning to how little money Peter usually had and how much even a small coin meant to him.
- Some students may think Grandfather does not want Heidi at all. Point out that his face softens when he sees her and that he takes her hand carefully. He is uncertain and gruff, but the text gives hints that he is not completely unwelcoming.

## Standards

| Standard | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Workbook Section(s)                                                             |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RL.3.1   | Ask and answer questions to demonstrate understanding of a text, referring explicitly to the text as the basis for the answers.                                                                                       | Think About the Story,<br>Evidence from the Story,<br>Multiple Choice Questions |
| RL.3.3   | Describe characters in a story (e.g., their traits, motivations, or feelings) and explain how their actions contribute to the sequence of events.                                                                     | Reading Between the Lines,<br>Dig Deeper, Character Chart                       |
| RL.3.4   | Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text, distinguishing literal from nonliteral language.                                                                                               | Words to Know                                                                   |
| RL.3.5   | Refer to parts of stories, dramas, and poems when writing or speaking about a text, using terms such as chapter, scene, and stanza; describe how each successive part builds on earlier sections.                     | Bonus Challenge, Thinking<br>Deeper                                             |
| RL.3.6   | Distinguish their own point of view from that of the narrator or those of the characters.                                                                                                                             | Dig Deeper, Reading Between<br>the Lines                                        |
| W.3.3    | Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, descriptive details, and clear event sequences.                                                                         | Creative Response                                                               |
| W.3.4    | With guidance and support from adults, produce writing in which the development and organization are appropriate to task and purpose.                                                                                 | Creative Response, Writing<br>Rubric                                            |
| W.3.5    | With guidance and support from peers and adults, develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, and editing.                                                                                         | Writing Rubric                                                                  |
| W.3.8    | Recall information from experiences or gather information from print and digital sources; take brief notes on sources and sort evidence into provided categories.                                                     | Evidence from the Story,<br>Words to Know                                       |
| W.3.10   | Write routinely over extended time frames (time for research, reflection, and revision) and shorter time frames (a single sitting or a day or two) for a range of discipline-specific tasks, purposes, and audiences. | Creative Response, Reflect on<br>Your Drawing, Thinking<br>Deeper               |

## Measurable Objectives

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- Students will identify key story details by answering literal comprehension questions about characters, setting, and events in Chapter 1.
- Students will define the six words — *avoid*, *consider*, *explore*, *journey*, *responsible*, and *treasure* — using context clues from the chapter and write an original sentence for each word.
- Students will make inferences about characters by explaining why Heidi feels excited, why Alm-Uncle seems lonely, and what Peter's reaction to the coin shows about him.
- Students will use evidence from the text, with page numbers, to support written answers in complete sentences.
- Students will write a letter from Heidi's point of view using the scaffolded letter template, following correct letter format with a greeting and a closing.
- Students will sequence seven events from Chapter 1 in the correct order.
- Students will complete a character chart describing how Heidi, Grandfather, and Peter look and act and what those details show about each character.
- Students will make a prediction about what will happen in the next chapter and explain their thinking.

## Get Ready to Read

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### FOCUS QUESTION

What is one place you have visited for the first time that felt like an adventure?

Think about each prompt below.

1. Think of a time you went somewhere new for the first time.
2. Write one word that tells how you felt when you got there.
3. Write one thing you saw or heard that you had never seen or heard before.

## Words to Know mini-lesson

**Purpose:** Students will learn six words from Chapter 1 by finding them in the text, using context clues to write definitions in their own words, and writing original sentences.

Write the six words on the board before the lesson: **avoid, consider, explore, journey, responsible, treasure**. Tell students that all six words appear in Chapter 1. Explain that good readers use the words around an unfamiliar word to figure out what it means. This is called using context clues.

Model the process with one word before asking students to work through the chart. A complete model is provided below.

Read aloud the sentence from page 7: *"Deta said goodbye to Barbara near this hut, and Barbara continued her journey up the mountain."*

Think aloud: *"Barbara is still going up the mountain. She is moving from one place to another place. A journey must mean a trip from one place to another."*

Write the definition on the board: **a trip from one place to another**

Write a sample sentence together as a class: *"Our class went on a journey to the science museum."*

Then ask students to complete the remaining five words in their workbook charts on their own or with a partner. Use the definitions and discussion notes below to check student responses and guide the class discussion after students finish the chart.

**Book sentence:** *"People avoid him because he looks and acts so scary."*

**Simple definition:** to stay away from someone or something on purpose

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "What do people do when something looks scary? Do they walk toward it or away from it?" The word *because* signals the reason, which helps students figure out the meaning.

**Sample student sentence:** I avoid the mud puddle so my shoes stay clean.

**Discussion prompt:** Why do the villagers avoid Alm-Uncle? What does that tell us about how he seems to other people?

**Book sentence:** *"You must be out of your mind to consider it."*

**Simple definition:** to think about doing something

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "Barbara thinks Deta is crazy for even thinking about this plan. What does that tell us about what consider means?" Point out that *out of your mind* means Barbara thinks it is a terrible idea even to think about.

**Sample student sentence:** I will consider which book I want to read next.

**Discussion prompt:** Why does Barbara think Deta is out of her mind to even consider leaving Heidi with Alm-Uncle?

**Book sentence:** *"It was an adventure for her, and she was eager to explore every corner."*

**Simple definition:** to look around a new place to find out what is there

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "What do you do when you visit a new place that excites you? The word *adventure* and the phrase *every corner* help us understand that Heidi wants to see and discover everything."

**Sample student sentence:** We explored the tide pools and found crabs and snails.

**Discussion prompt:** What does it tell us about Heidi that she wants to explore every corner of the hut instead of feeling scared or shy?

**Book sentence:** *"Deta said goodbye to Barbara near this hut, and Barbara continued her journey up the mountain."*

**Simple definition:** a trip from one place to another

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "Barbara is still walking up the mountain. She is going somewhere. A journey is a trip you take to get somewhere."

**Sample student sentence:** The long journey by train took three hours.

**Discussion prompt:** Who is taking a journey in this chapter? Is it just Barbara, or are other characters making a journey too?

**Book sentence:** *"Tobias learned carpentry and was very responsible, unlike his father."*

**Simple definition:** doing what you are supposed to do and taking care of your duties

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "The sentence says Tobias was responsible, *unlike* his father. We know from the story that the father made bad choices and lost everything. So responsible must mean the opposite of that." The word *unlike* is the key contrast clue here.

**Sample student sentence:** She was responsible and always fed her dog before school.

**Discussion prompt:** How is Tobias different from his father, Alm-Uncle? What does being responsible look like in real life?

**Book sentence:** *"Peter didn't often get such a treasure."*

**Simple definition:** something that is very special or valuable to you

**Context clue tip:** Ask students: "Peter jumped up right away when Deta showed him the coin. He dropped it deep into his pocket so it would not fall out. That tells us the coin was very important to him. A treasure is something very special or valuable." Note for teachers: students may say treasure means gold or gems. Affirm that meaning and then explain that the word can also describe anything that feels very special or valuable to a person.

**Sample student sentence:** My grandmother's bracelet is a treasure to me.

**Discussion prompt:** Why was the five-penny coin such a treasure to Peter? What does that tell us about Peter's life?

| Support                                                                                                                                           | On Level                                                                                                       | Extension                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provide the definitions below each word in the chart. Ask students to copy the definition in their own words and write a sentence using the word. | Students complete the full chart independently or with a partner, using context clues from the book sentences. | Ask students to choose two words and explain in writing how those two words connect to the same character or event in the chapter. |

- Students may copy the book sentence as the definition. Remind them that a definition explains what the word means, not just what happened in the story.
- Students may confuse *treasure* with only meaning gold or buried objects. Help them see that the word can describe anything a person values very much.
- Students may struggle with *responsible* as an adjective. If needed, ask: "What does a responsible person do? What does an irresponsible person do?" Connecting to Tobias versus his father helps make this concrete.

After students finish their charts, go through each word as a class. Call on volunteers to share their definitions and sentences. Correct any definitions that are too broad or too close to a copy of the book sentence. End by asking: "Which of these six words could describe Heidi herself, and why?" Students may point to *explore* (she is eager to look around) or *journey* (she is on a trip up the mountain). Accept any reasonable answers supported by the text.

## Guided Reading with pause points

Read Chapter 1 of *Heidi* with your students. Stop at each pause point to ask the questions below. Encourage students to look back at the page to find their answers.

Read from the beginning of the chapter through "Barbara promised she would not talk about it with anyone."

### Pause Point 1

1. What is Heidi wearing when she and Deta climb the mountain path?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: Heidi is wearing several layers of clothes and a big red shawl, with heavy boots.*

2. The word **consider** appears on page 3. Barbara says, "You must be out of your mind to *consider* it." Look at what Deta just told Barbara she was going to do. What does *consider* mean?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: To think about doing something. Deta is thinking about leaving Heidi with her grandfather, and Barbara cannot believe she would even think about it.*

3. Why does Deta say she cannot keep Heidi with her?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: Deta has been offered a new job in Frankfurt and cannot take Heidi with her.*

Read from "Barbara had moved to the village after getting married" through "Barbara continued her journey up the mountain."

### Pause Point 2

1. The word **avoid** is on page 4. The text says, "People *avoid* him because he looks and acts so scary." What do the people in the village do when they see Alm-Uncle?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: They stay away from him. To avoid someone means to stay away from that person on purpose.*

2. What did Alm-Uncle do with the big farm he had many years ago?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: He spent too much money and made bad choices, so he lost it all.*

3. The word **journey** is on page 7. It says Barbara "continued her journey up the mountain." Based on what Barbara is doing, what does *journey* mean?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: A journey is a trip from one place to another. Barbara is traveling up the mountain, so that trip is her journey.*

4. Why do you think Alm-Uncle stopped talking to people and moved alone to the mountains?

[question-type: inference]

*Expected answer: Students may say he was very sad after his son Tobias and daughter-in-law Adelheid both died, and he did not want to be around others anymore. Accept reasonable answers supported by the text.*

Read from "The little hut was home to an eleven-year-old boy" through "He hurried down the straightest path and returned again in a short time."

### Pause Point 3

1. Why does Heidi take off her shoes, socks, and extra dresses on the mountain path?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: She is too hot and her heavy clothes make it hard to climb. She wants to move as easily as Peter and the goats.*



2. The word **responsible** is on page 5. Deta says Tobias "was very responsible, unlike his father." Alm-Uncle made bad choices and lost his farm. What does it mean to be *responsible*?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: To be responsible means to do what you are supposed to do and make good choices. Tobias did the right things, while his father did not.*

3. The word **treasure** is on page 11. Peter "didn't often get such a treasure." The treasure is the five-penny coin Deta gives him. What does the word *treasure* tell you about how Peter felt about that coin?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: A treasure is something very special and valuable. Using that word tells us the coin was very important to Peter, even though it was small.*

4. Peter does not want to go back down the hill to get Heidi's clothes. What changes his mind right away?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: Deta offers him a five-penny coin, and he jumps up and hurries down the hill.*

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Read from "After almost an hour, they reached Heidi's grandfather's hut" to the end of the chapter.

#### **Pause Point 4**

1. The word **explore** is on page 12. Heidi "was eager to *explore* every corner." What is Heidi doing when she bounces around looking at everything?

[question-type: and inference]

*Expected answer: She is looking around and checking out new places and things she has never seen before. To explore means to look around somewhere new.*

2. What does Grandfather do when he hears Heidi call out "Good evening, Grandfather"?

[question-type: comprehension]

*Expected answer: He looks up and his face softens into a smile. He seems pleased to have visitors.*

3. Grandfather is worried that Heidi will start crying and miss Deta. What does that worry tell you about what kind of life he has been living up on the mountain?

[question-type: inference]

*Expected answer: He has been living alone for a long time and is not used to being around children or taking care of anyone. He does not know what to do when a child is upset.*

4. Think about Heidi and Barbara. They both learn that Heidi will live with Alm-Uncle. Barbara says it is a terrible idea, but Heidi calls out "Good evening, Grandfather" and bounces around looking at everything. Why do you think they feel so differently?

[question-type: analysis]

*Expected answer: Barbara is a grown-up who has heard scary stories about Alm-Uncle and worries about what could go wrong. Heidi is a young child who sees it as a new adventure. She has not heard the same stories and is not afraid.*

5. At the end of the chapter, Deta leaves Heidi with her grandfather. Do you think this was the right choice for Deta to make? Use what you read to explain your answer.

[question-type: evaluation]

*Expected answer: Accept a range of answers. Students may say it was not right because Alm-Uncle is gruff and lives alone with no one to help him care for a child. Others may say Deta had no other choice and that Grandfather is family. Look for students to support their opinion with at least one detail from the chapter.*



## Tiered Discussion

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**1. What does Heidi say when Deta asks if she is tired from climbing the mountain?**

[question-type: comprehension]

Students should point directly to the text. Heidi says she is not tired but hot. This checks that students read carefully and can locate a simple answer in a single sentence.

**2. The word *journey* appears when Barbara continues her journey up the mountain. What do you think the word *journey* means? Use what happens in the sentence to help you explain.**

[question-type: and inference]

Students should connect the word to the idea of traveling or walking from one place to another. Guide them to notice that Barbara is moving up the mountain, which helps show that a journey is a trip someone takes. Accept answers that include the idea of going from one place to another.

**3. Why do you think Heidi feels excited rather than scared about arriving at her grandfather's hut, even though Barbara and Deta both seem worried about it?**

[question-type: inference]

Students should think about what the text shows about Heidi's personality. She takes off her heavy clothes, runs with the goats, and wants to explore every corner of the hut. Guide students to connect these details to the idea that Heidi sees the mountain as an adventure rather than something frightening. Accept reasonable answers that use details from the chapter.

**4. Look at what Heidi does on the path up the mountain and how she acts when she arrives at the hut. What do these actions show about the kind of person Heidi is?**

[question-type: analysis]

Students should connect specific actions, such as taking off her heavy clothes to move freely like the goats, greeting her grandfather cheerfully, and wanting to explore every corner, to what those actions reveal about her character. Guide students to use the word *explore* and other from the chapter. Look for answers that go beyond just retelling what she does and begin to explain what it shows about who she is.

**5. Do you think Deta made a good choice by leaving Heidi with Alm-Uncle? Use details from the chapter to explain your thinking.**

[question-type: evaluation]

This question has no single correct answer. Some students may say Deta had no choice because of her new job and that Grandfather is family. Others may say it was a bad choice because people in the village avoid Alm-Uncle and Barbara thought Deta was out of her mind to consider it. Encourage students to use evidence from both sides. The goal is for students to support their opinion with at least one detail from the text.

Answers aligned to workbook pages

| Character Name | What They Look Like and How They Act                                                                                                                                                                                                 | What This Shows About Them                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heidi          | About five years old with rosy cheeks and tanned skin.<br>She is energetic, curious, and cheerful. She takes off her heavy clothes, asks Peter lots of questions, and greets her grandfather with a big smile. (pp. 1, 8, 9, 11, 12) | She is free-spirited, brave, and full of joy. She is not afraid of new things and finds adventure in everything around her.                                                        |
| Grandfather    | An old man with a long gray beard and bushy eyebrows that join in the middle. He uses a twisted walking stick. He sits quietly on his bench and speaks in a gruff voice. (pp. 4, 11, 12)                                             | He seems tough and grumpy on the outside, but his face softens into a smile when Heidi arrives. He is lonely and unsure how to care for a child, but he is not truly cold-hearted. |
| Peter          | An eleven-year-old goat herder who wears light clothes and goes barefoot. He moves easily on the mountain. He grins when he sees Heidi in her simple clothes and is quick to act when Deta offers him a coin. (pp. 8, 9, 11)         | He is a practical, simple boy who spends most of his time alone with goats. He is motivated by small rewards and is happy with simple pleasures, like a five-penny coin.           |

Students draw Heidi taking off her heavy clothes and shoes on the mountain path so she could move freely like the goats. Look for the following details in student drawings:

- Heidi on a mountain path
- A pile of clothes, shoes, and socks nearby
- Peter and goats on the path
- Heidi in a simple undershirt looking happy or free

Drawings do not need to be detailed, but they should show the key moment from the text on pages 8 and 9. Students complete three sentence stems. Accept any thoughtful response connected to the drawing and the chapter. Sample answers are below.

1. In my drawing, *Heidi is smiling on the mountain path* because *she feels free after taking off her heavy clothes*.
2. One detail I included is *the pile of shoes and dresses on the ground next to the path*.
3. I would add *the goats jumping over rocks* because *Heidi wanted to move just like them*.

Students number the events in the order they happen in Chapter 1. Correct order is below.

| NUMBER | EVENT                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5      | Deta and Heidi climb the mountain path from Maienfeld on a sunny morning in June.                                                                                              |
| 7      | Barbara joins Deta and tells her, "You must be out of your mind to consider it," about leaving Heidi with Alm-Uncle.                                                           |
| 3      | Deta explains that Tobias learned carpentry and was very responsible, unlike his father, Alm-Uncle.                                                                            |
| 6      | Deta said goodbye to Barbara near this hut, and Barbara continued her journey up the mountain.                                                                                 |
| 1      | Heidi takes off her heavy shoes, socks, and extra dresses, and Peter retrieves them after Deta gives him a coin, which was such a treasure he dropped it deep into his pocket. |

| NUMBER | EVENT                                                                                                                  |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2      | Heidi, Peter, and the goats reach Alm-Uncle's hut, and Heidi calls out, "Good evening, Grandfather!"                   |
| 4      | It was an adventure for her, and she was eager to explore every corner of her grandfather's hut high in the mountains. |

**Correct sequence by number: 5, 7, 3, 6, 1, 2, 4.**

*Note: The sequence above reflects the order in which events occur in the chapter. Events 5, 7, 3, and 6 happen in the first half of the chapter as Deta and Barbara walk and talk. Events 1, 2, and 4 happen as the children and Deta reach the top of the mountain.*

Students make a prediction about what will happen in the next chapter. There is no single correct answer. A strong prediction will be connected to events in Chapter 1. Look for reasoning that is tied to the text. Sample predictions are below.

- I predict that Heidi and her grandfather will slowly get to know each other because at the end of Chapter 1 he seemed softened by her cheerful greeting and Deta was about to leave her with him.
- I predict that Heidi will go out with Peter and the goats because she seemed very interested in them on the way up the mountain.
- I predict that Grandfather will have a hard time at first caring for Heidi because he said he would not know what to do if she cried for Deta.

Prompt students who are stuck by asking: What do you think Grandfather and Heidi will do now that Deta is gone? Do you think Heidi will be happy living on the mountain?

## Struggling Readers / ELL / Advanced Students support

Show students a simple picture of a mountain path. Ask: "Has anyone ever climbed a big hill? What was hard about it?" This builds background before they meet Heidi on the steep path.

Pre-teach the six words using the simple definitions below. Write each word on the board with a picture or quick sketch next to it.

| WORD        | SIMPLE DEFINITION (GRADE 3)                                 | QUICK EXAMPLE                                          |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| avoid       | to stay away from something or someone on purpose           | "I avoid the puddle so I don't get my shoes wet."      |
| consider    | to think about doing something                              | "I am going to consider which book to read next."      |
| explore     | to look around a new place and find out what is there       | "We explored the playground and found a hidden slide." |
| journey     | a trip from one place to another, often a long one          | "The drive to Grandma's house was a long journey."     |
| responsible | doing what you are supposed to do and taking care of things | "A responsible student turns in homework on time."     |
| treasure    | something that is very special and worth a lot to you       | "That old photo was a treasure to him."                |

Pair struggling readers with a partner. Take turns reading one paragraph each. After each page, the partner who is listening tells the reader one thing that just happened. This keeps both students engaged and checks understanding in small steps.

Use the "point to it" strategy for the Think About the Story questions. Remind students that every answer can be found and pointed to in the text. Encourage them to put their finger on the sentence before they write anything down.

Provide these frames for students who need help getting started on written answers.

- The little girl's name is \_\_\_\_.
- Heidi is not tired. She says she is \_\_\_\_.
- Deta is going to work in \_\_\_\_.
- Heidi takes off her \_\_\_\_ and leaves them on the path.
- Deta gives Peter a \_\_\_\_ to go get Heidi's clothes.
- When they arrive at the hut, \_\_\_\_ is sitting on the bench outside.

Some students may not know how to start a letter. Give them this starter frame on a separate strip of paper to glue into their workbook or copy:

Dear \_\_\_\_,

I just arrived at my grandfather's hut on the mountain. To get here, I had to \_\_\_\_\_. On the way up, I felt \_\_\_\_\_ because \_\_\_\_\_. When I got here, I saw \_\_\_\_\_. I think living here will be \_\_\_\_\_ because \_\_\_\_\_.

Sincerely,

Heidi

Cut the seven events from the Bonus Challenge into strips and let struggling readers physically arrange them in order before numbering. This hands-on step lowers the challenge of holding the sequence in working memory.

Point out that the story takes place in Switzerland. Names like "Alm-Uncle," "Maienfeld," "Tobias," and "Adelheid" are not English names. Explain that "Alm" means a high mountain pasture in the language spoken there. Tell students it is fine to say these names in a way that feels comfortable when reading aloud.

Several phrases in Chapter 1 may be confusing. Go over these before or during reading:

- **"out of your mind"** (p. 3) — this does not mean something is wrong with your brain. It means "that is a very bad idea."
- **"glued to the spot"** (p. 9) — Peter is not actually glued. It means he was standing completely still and not moving.
- **"do his part"** (p. 4) — means it is the grandfather's turn to help and take care of Heidi.
- **"nimble"** (p. 9) — able to move quickly and easily.

Draw or display a simple diagram on the board showing the mountain path. Label: village at the bottom, Barbara's hut in the middle, Alm-Uncle's hut at the top. As you read, point to where each scene takes place. This helps ELL students follow the movement of the story without getting lost.

Pair ELL students with a fluent English speaker for partner reading. After each section, the ELL student summarizes in one or two sentences what happened. The partner can help with missing words, but the ELL student should speak first.

Allow ELL students to write the definition in their home language in parentheses next to the English definition in the Words to Know chart. This is a bridge strategy, not a shortcut — they must still write the English definition and their own English sentence.

Before writing, let ELL students share their answer to the focus question out loud with a partner. Provide this spoken frame: "One place I visited for the first time was \_\_\_\_\_. It felt like an adventure because \_\_\_\_\_." Then they write their answer.

After students complete the Dig Deeper questions in their workbook, use these follow-up prompts to push their thinking further:

- Deta says she has already done "a lot" for Heidi. Do you agree? Use at least two details from the chapter to support your answer.
- Barbara says Alm-Uncle is "so different from everyone else." What does the chapter show us about what it means to be truly alone? Is Alm-Uncle alone by choice or by chance? Explain using evidence.
- Heidi does not seem scared of her grandfather even though all the adults are. What does this tell you about how children sometimes see people more clearly than grown-ups do?

Ask advanced students to notice how Johanna Spyri uses the setting — the mountain, the path, the steep climb, the wind, the view — to tell us something about the characters and their feelings. Have them find two or three details from the chapter where the setting matches or contrasts with a character's mood, and write a short paragraph explaining what they found.

After completing the Character Chart, ask advanced students to write a short paragraph (four to six sentences) from Deta's point of view explaining her decision to leave Heidi with Alm-Uncle. Then ask them to write a second paragraph from Alm-Uncle's point of view about what he is thinking when Deta walks away. Remind them to use details from the chapter to make their writing feel true to the story.

After students number the seven events in order, ask them to write one sentence explaining how they decided where to place the hardest event to sequence. This builds metacognitive awareness about using text evidence to confirm sequence.

For the Thinking Deeper section, ask advanced students to write not just a prediction but a reason tied to character.

Their prediction should follow this format: "I predict \_\_\_\_ will happen because the author showed us that \_\_\_\_ [character] tends to \_\_\_\_ [behavior or feeling from the chapter]."

## Common student questions

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Why does Deta leave Heidi with her grandfather if he is so scary?

Students often feel confused or upset by this. Help them see that Deta is not a bad person, but she is in a hard situation. She has been offered a job in Frankfurt and cannot bring a young child with her. She also believes that Alm-Uncle is Heidi's family, and that family should help take care of Heidi. You can ask students: "Have you ever had to do something hard because you had no other choice?" This helps them connect to Deta's decision without simply judging her as mean.

If students ask whether Deta is being selfish, that is a great sign of deeper thinking. Encourage them to look at both sides. Deta did care for Heidi for four years after her mother died. She is not abandoning Heidi with a stranger — she is leaving her with a blood relative. You can use this as an entry point into the "Reading Between the Lines" questions.

Why does everyone call him "Alm-Uncle" if he is not really their uncle?

This is a very common point of confusion. Explain to students that "Uncle" was a nickname the villagers gave him long ago because he was an older man they all knew. Then, when he moved up to a place on the mountain called the Alm, the nickname grew into "Alm-Uncle." It stuck even after he stopped being friendly with people. You can compare it to how students sometimes call a family friend "Auntie" or "Uncle" even if that person is not truly related to them.

Why does Heidi take off her clothes on the mountain path?

Students often find this funny or strange. The text explains clearly that Heidi is very hot from wearing too many layers — she has her Sunday clothes on top of her everyday clothes because Deta did not want to carry extra things. Heidi sees the goats and Peter moving freely and easily, and she wants to feel that way too. This is a literal question with a clear answer in the text, so guide students back to page 8 to find it themselves before you explain it. You can also use this moment to introduce the idea that Heidi acts on her feelings right away. She is not shy or worried about what others will think. This detail connects well to the character chart activity and the "Dig Deeper" questions.

What is a five-penny coin worth? Why is it such a big deal to Peter?

Students may not understand why Peter is so excited about a small coin. Explain that Peter is a poor boy who herds goats all day and earns very little. The text says "Peter didn't often get such a treasure," which tells us that even a small amount of money felt like a lot to him. You can ask students to think about a time they received something small that felt very special to them. This helps them understand Peter's reaction without needing to know the exact value of old Swiss coins.

The word *treasure* connects directly here. Remind students that a treasure does not have to be gold or jewels — it is anything that feels very valuable to the person who has it.

Is Grandfather a bad person?

Many students will assume Grandfather is a villain because the villagers are afraid of him and Barbara warns Deta not to leave Heidi there. Help students slow down and look at what the text actually shows. When Heidi calls out "Good evening, Grandfather!" the text says his face softens into a smile. He also takes her hand carefully and looks at her. These are not the actions of a truly bad person.

Explain that Grandfather has been through a lot of loss — his son Tobias died, and Tobias's wife Adelheid died not long after. He pushed people away and now lives alone. His gruffness comes from sadness and loneliness, not from being cruel. Encourage students to ask: "Can a person seem scary on the outside but still have good feelings on the inside?" This sets up strong thinking for chapters ahead.

Why does Grandfather tell Peter to leave so quickly?



Students may wonder if Grandfather is being mean to Peter. Help them see that Grandfather tells Peter to take the goats because Peter is late in his job of returning the goats to the village. Grandfather is not punishing Peter — he is being practical. It also gives Grandfather a moment alone with Deta to talk about Heidi without a child listening. You can point out that Grandfather speaks very directly and does not waste words, which is part of how the author shows his personality.

What does "journey" mean? Is it just a walk?

Students may think a journey is just any walk or trip. Help them understand that a journey usually means a longer or more important trip that takes effort. On page 7, Barbara "continued her journey up the mountain," which shows that even a walk up a steep mountain can be called a journey because it takes real work and time. Ask students: "What makes a trip feel like a journey and not just a quick walk to the store?" This helps them feel the weight of the word in context.

What does "responsible" mean in this chapter?

The text says Tobias was "very responsible, unlike his father." Help students understand that being responsible means doing what you are supposed to do and taking care of your duties. Tobias learned his trade well and worked hard. His father, Alm-Uncle, made bad choices, spent too much money, and hurt the people around him. The word is used here to contrast father and son. Ask students: "What is one thing you are responsible for at home or at school?" This makes the definition feel real and personal.

## Creative Response common errors

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Because students may already know the story or guess ahead, some write about events that have not happened yet, such as Heidi making friends with Clara or going inside the hut for a meal. Remind students that the letter is about arriving at the hut in Chapter 1 only. Ask: "Did we read about that in this chapter? Where in the chapter does it say that?"

Some students write only general feelings such as "it was fun" or "I liked it." Prompt students to look back at the chapter and find at least one specific detail Heidi could mention, such as the three tall fir trees, Grandfather's long grey beard, or the beautiful view of the valley. Ask: "What is one thing Heidi actually saw or did that she could tell Barbara about?"

Some students mix up Barbara with Deta and write as if Barbara already knows what happened because she was there. Remind students that Barbara said goodbye to Deta partway up the mountain on page 7 and did not come to the hut. Heidi would be telling Barbara something Barbara did not see. Ask: "Did Barbara go all the way up to Grandfather's hut, or did she turn back?"